

First-born, The

Of man and beast dedicated to God.

Exodus 13:2 Sanctify unto me all the firstborn, whatsoever openeth the womb among the children of Israel, both of man and of beast: it is mine.

Exodus 22:29 Thou shalt not delay to offer the first of thy ripe fruits, and of thy liquors: the firstborn of thy sons shalt thou give unto me.

Dedicated to commemorate the sparing of the first-born of Israel.

Exodus 13:15 And it came to pass, when Pharaoh would hardly let us go, that the LORD slew all the firstborn in the land of Egypt, both the firstborn of man, and the firstborn of beast: therefore I sacrifice to the LORD all that openeth the matrix, being males; but all the firstborn of my children I redeem.

Numbers 3:13 Because all the firstborn are mine; for on the day that I smote all the firstborn in the land of Egypt I hallowed unto me all the firstborn in Israel, both man and beast: mine shall they be: I am the LORD.

Numbers 8:17 For all the firstborn of the children of Israel are mine, both man and beast: on the day that I smote every firstborn in the land of Egypt I sanctified them for myself.

OF CLEAN BEASTS

Not to labor.

Deuteronomy 15:19 All the firstling males that come of thy herd and of thy flock thou shalt sanctify unto the LORD thy God: thou shalt do no work with the firstling of thy bullock, nor shear the firstling of thy sheep.

Not shorn.

Deuteronomy 15:19 All the firstling males that come of thy herd and of thy flock thou shalt sanctify unto the LORD thy God: thou shalt do no work with the firstling of thy bullock, nor shear the firstling of thy sheep.

Not taken from the Dam for seven days.

Exodus 22:30 Likewise shalt thou do with thine oxen, and with thy sheep: seven days it shall be with his Dam; on the eighth day thou shalt give it me.

Leviticus 22:27 When a bullock, or a sheep, or a goat, is brought forth, then it shall be seven days under the Dam; and from the eighth day and thenceforth it shall be accepted for an offering made by fire unto the LORD.

Offered in sacrifice.

Numbers 18:17 But the firstling of a cow, or the firstling of a sheep, or the firstling of a goat, thou shalt not redeem; they are holy: thou shalt sprinkle their blood upon the altar, and shalt burn their fat for an offering made by fire, for a sweet savour unto the LORD.

Could not be a free-will offering.

Leviticus 27:26 Only the firstling of the beasts, which should be the LORDS' firstling, no man shall sanctify it; whether it be ox, or sheep: it is the LORDS'.

Antiquity of offering.

Genesis 4:4 And Abel, he also brought of the firstlings of his flock and of the fat thereof. And the LORD had respect unto Abel and to his offering:

Flesh of, the priests' portion.

Numbers 18:18 And the flesh of them shall be thine, as the wave breast and as the right shoulder are thine.

OF CLEAN BEASTS

To be redeemed.

Numbers 18:15 Every thing that openeth the matrix in all flesh, which they bring unto the LORD, whether it be of men or beasts, shall be thine: nevertheless the firstborn of man shalt thou surely redeem, and the firstling of unclean beasts shalt thou redeem.

Law of redemption for.

Numbers 18:16 And those that are to be redeemed from a month old shalt thou redeem, according to thine estimation, for the money of five shekels, after the shekel of the sanctuary, which is twenty gerahs.

Of the Ass to be redeemed with lamb or its neck broken.

Exodus 13:13 And every firstling of an Ass thou shalt redeem with a lamb; and if thou wilt not redeem it, then thou shalt break his neck: and all the firstborn of man among thy children shalt thou redeem.

Exodus 34:20 But the firstling of an Ass thou shalt redeem with a lamb: and if thou redeem him not, then shalt thou break his neck. All the firstborn of thy sons thou shalt redeem. And none shall appear before me empty.

OF Israel,

Tribe of Levi taken for.

Numbers 3:12 And I, behold, I have taken the Levites from among the children of Israel instead of all the firstborn that openeth the matrix among the children of Israel:

therefore the Levites shall be mine;

Numbers 3:40-43 And the LORD said unto Moses, Number all the firstborn of the males of the children of Israel from a month old and upward, and take the number of their names. 41 And thou shalt take the Levites for me (I am the LORD) instead of all the firstborn among the children of Israel; and the cattle of the Levites instead of all the firstlings among the cattle of the children of Israel. 42 And Moses numbered, as the LORD commanded him, all the firstborn among the children of Israel. 43 And all the firstborn males by the number of names, from a month old and upward, of those that were numbered of them, were twenty and two thousand two hundred and threescore and thirteen.

Numbers 8:18 And I have taken the Levites for all the firstborn of the children of Israel. To be redeemed.

Exodus 34:20 But the firstling of an Ass thou shalt redeem with a lamb: and if thou redeem him not, then shalt thou break his neck. All the firstborn of thy sons thou shalt redeem. And none shall appear before me empty.

Numbers 18:15 Every thing that openeth the matrix in all flesh, which they bring unto the LORD, whether it be of men or beasts, shall be thine: nevertheless the firstborn of man shalt thou surely redeem, and the firstling of unclean beasts shalt thou redeem.

Price of redemption for.

Numbers 3:46-47 And for those that are to be redeemed of the two hundred and threescore and thirteen of the firstborn of the children of Israel, which are more than the Levites; 47 Thou shalt even take five shekels apiece by the poll, after the shekel of the sanctuary shalt thou take them: (the shekel is twenty gerahs:)

Price of, given to the priests.

Numbers 3:48-51 And thou shalt give the money, wherewith the odd number of them is to be redeemed, unto Aaron and to his sons. 49 And Moses took the redemption money of them that were over and above them that were redeemed by the Levites: 50 Of the firstborn of the children of Israel took he the money; a thousand three hundred and threescore and five shekels, after the shekel of the sanctuary: 51 And Moses gave the money of them that were redeemed unto Aaron and to his sons, according to the word of the LORD, as the LORD commanded Moses.

Laws respecting, restored after the captivity.

Nehemiah 10:36 Also the firstborn of our sons, and of our cattle, as it is written in The Law, and the firstlings of our herds and of our flocks, to bring to the house of our God, unto the priests that minister in the house of our God:

Laws respecting, observed at Christ's birth.

Luke 2:22-23 And when the days of her purification according to The Law of Moses were accomplished, they brought him to Jerusalem, to present him to the Lord; 23 (As it is written in The Law of the Lord, Every male that openeth the womb shall be called holy to the Lord;)

The beginning of strength and excellency of power.

Genesis 49:3 Reuben, thou Art my firstborn, my might, and the beginning of my strength, the excellency of dignity, and the excellency of power:

Deuteronomy 21:17 But he shall acknowledge the son of the hated for the firstborn, by giving him a double portion of all that he hath: for he is the beginning of his strength;

the right of the firstborn is his.

Precious and valuable.

Micah 6:7 Will the LORD be pleased with thousands of rams, or with ten thousands of rivers of oil? shall I give my firstborn for my transgression, the fruit of my body for the Sin of my soul?

Zechariah 12:10 And I will pour upon the house of David, and upon the inhabitants of Jerusalem, the spirit of grace and of supplications: and they shall look upon me whom they have pierced, and they shall mourn for him, as one mourneth for his only son, and shall be in bitterness for him, as one that is in bitterness for his firstborn.

Objects of special love.

Genesis 25:28 And Isaac loved Esau, because he did eat of his venison: but Rebekah loved Jacob.

Jeremiah 31:9 They shall come with weeping, and with supplications will I lead them: I will cause them to walk by the rivers of waters in a straight way, wherein they shall not stumble: for I am a Father to Israel, and Ephraim is my firstborn.

Jeremiah 31:20 Is Ephraim my dear son? is he a pleasant child? for since I spake against him, I do earnestly remember him still: therefore my Bowels are troubled for him; I will surely have mercy upon him, saith the LORD.

PRIVILEGES OF;

Precedence in the family.

Genesis 48:13-14 And Joseph took them both, Ephraim in his right hand toward Israel's left hand, and Manasseh in his left hand toward Israel's right hand, and brought them near unto him. 14 And Israel stretched out his right hand, and laid it upon Ephraim's head, who was the younger, and his left hand upon Manasseh's head, guiding his hands wittingly; for Manasseh was the firstborn.

Authority over the younger children.

Genesis 27:29 Let people serve thee, and nations bow down to thee: be lord over thy Brethren, and let thy mother's sons bow down to thee: cursed be every one that curseth thee, and blessed be he that blesseth thee.

1 Samuel 20:29 And he said, Let me go, I pray thee; for our family hath a sacrifice in the city; and my brother, he hath commanded me to be there: and now, if I have found favour in thine eyes, let me get away, I pray thee, and see my Brethren. Therefore he cometh not unto the king's table.

Special blessing by the Father.

Genesis 27:4 And make me savoury meat, such as I love, and bring it to me, that I may eat; that my soul may bless thee before I die.

Genesis 27:35 And he said, Thy brother came with subtilty, and hath taken away thy blessing.

The Father's title and power.

2 Chronicles 21:3 And their Father gave them great gifts of silver, and of gold, and of precious things, with fenced cities in Judah: but the kingdom gave he to Jehoram; because he was the firstborn.

A double portion of inheritance.

Deuteronomy 21:17 But he shall acknowledge the son of the hated for the firstborn, by giving him a double portion of all that he hath: for he is the beginning of his strength; the right of the firstborn is his.

In case of Death the next brother to raise up seed to.

Deuteronomy 25:5-6 If Brethren dwell together, and one of them die, and have no child, the wife of the Dead shall not marry without unto a stranger: her husband's brother

shall go in unto her, and take her to him to wife, and perform the duty of an husband's brother unto her. 6 And it shall be, that the firstborn which she beareth shall succeed in the name of his brother which is Dead, that his name be not put out of Israel.

Not to be alienated by parents through caprice.

Deuteronomy 21:15-16 If a man have two wives, one beloved, and another hated, and they have born him children, both the beloved and the hated; and if the firstborn son be hers that was hated: 16 Then it shall be, when he maketh his sons to inherit that which he hath, that he may not make the son of the beloved firstborn before the son of the hated, which is indeed the firstborn:

Could be forfeited by misconduct.

Genesis 49:3-4 Reuben, thou Art my firstborn, my might, and the beginning of my strength, the excellency of dignity, and the excellency of power: 4 Unstable as water, thou shalt not excel; because thou wentest up to thy Father's bed; then defiledst thou it: he went up to my couch.

Genesis 49:8 Judah, thou Art he whom thy Brethren shall praise: thy hand shall be in the neck of thine enemies; thy Father's children shall bow down before thee.

1 Chronicles 5:1 Now the sons of Reuben the firstborn of Israel, (for he was the firstborn; but, forasmuch as he defiled his Father's bed, his birthright was given unto the sons of Joseph the son of Israel: and the genealogy is not to be reckoned after the birthright.

Could be sold.

Genesis 25:31 And Jacob said, Sell me this day thy birthright.

Genesis 25:33 And Jacob said, Swear to me this day; and he sware unto him: and he sold his birthright unto Jacob.

INSTANCES OF SUPERSEDED;

Cain.

Genesis 4:4-5 And Abel, he also brought of the firstlings of his flock and of the fat thereof. And the LORD had respect unto Abel and to his offering: 5 But unto Cain and to his offering he had not respect. And Cain was very wroth, and his Countenance fell. Japheth.

Genesis 10:21 Unto Shem also, the Father of all the children of Eber, the brother of Japheth the elder, even to him were children born.

Ishmael.

Genesis 17:19-21 And God said, Sarah thy wife shall bear thee a son indeed; and thou shalt call his name Isaac: and I will establish my covenant with him for an everlasting covenant, and with his seed after him. 20 And as for Ishmael, I have heard thee:

Behold, I have blessed him, and will make him fruitful, and will multiply him exceedingly; twelve Princes shall he Beget, and I will make him a great nation. 21 But my covenant will I establish with Isaac, which Sarah shall bear unto thee at this set time in the next year.

Esau.

Genesis 25:23 And the LORD said unto her, Two nations are in thy womb, and two manner of people shall be separated from thy Bowels; and the one people shall be stronger than the other people; and the elder shall serve the younger.

Romans 9:12-13 It was said unto her, The elder shall serve the younger. 13 As it is written, Jacob have I loved, but Esau have I hated.

Manasseh.

Genesis 48:15-20 And he blessed Joseph, and said, God, before whom my Fathers Abraham and Isaac did walk, the God which fed me all my life long unto this day, 16

The Angel which redeemed me from all evil, bless the lads; and let my name be named on them, and the name of my Fathers Abraham and Isaac; and let them grow into a multitude in the midst of the earth. 17 And when Joseph saw that his Father laid his right hand upon the head of Ephraim, it displeased him: and he held up his Father's hand, to remove it from Ephraim's head unto Manasseh's head. 18 And Joseph said unto his Father, Not so, my Father: for this is the firstborn; put thy right hand upon his head. ...

Reuben, ect.

1 Chronicles 5:1-2 Now the sons of Reuben the firstborn of Israel, (for he was the firstborn; but, forasmuch as he defiled his Father's bed, his birthright was given unto the sons of Joseph the son of Israel: and the genealogy is not to be reckoned after the birthright. 2 For Judah prevailed above his Brethren, and of him came the chief ruler; but the birthright was Joseph's:)

Aaron.

Exodus 7:1-2 And the LORD said unto Moses, See, I have made thee a god to Pharaoh: and Aaron thy brother shall be thy prophet. 2 Thou shalt speak all that I command thee: and Aaron thy brother shall speak unto Pharaoh, that he send the children of Israel out of his land.

David's brothers.

1 Samuel 16:6-12 And it came to pass, when they were come, that he looked on Eliab, and said, Surely the LORDS' anointed is before him. 7 But the LORD said unto Samuel, Look not on his Countenance, or on the height of his stature; because I have refused him: for the LORD seeth not as man seeth; for man looketh on the outward appearance, but the LORD looketh on the heart. 8 Then Jesse called Abinadab, and made him pass before Samuel. And he said, Neither hath the LORD Chosen this. 9 Then Jesse made Shammah to pass by. And he said, Neither hath the LORD Chosen this. ...

Adonijah.

1 Kings 2:15 And he said, Thou knowest that the kingdom was mine, and that all Israel set their faces on me, that I should reign: howbeit the kingdom is turned about, and is become my brother's: for it was his from the LORD.

1 Kings 2:22 And king Solomon answered and said unto his mother, And why dost thou ask Abishag the Shunammite for Adonijah? ask for him the kingdom also; for he is mine elder brother; even for him, and for Abiathar the priest, and for Joab the son of Zeruiah.

ILLUSTRATIVE OF

The dignity, ect. of Christ.

Psalm 89:27 Also I will make him my firstborn, higher than the kings of the earth.

Romans 8:29 For whom he did foreknow, he also did predestinate to be conformed to the image of his Son, that he might be the firstborn among many Brethren.

Colossians 1:18 And he is the head of the body, the Church: who is the beginning, the firstborn from the Dead; that in all things he might have the preeminence.

The dignity, ect. of the Church.

Hebrews 12:23 To the general assembly and Church of the firstborn, which are written in heaven, and to God the Judge of all, and to the spirits of just men made perfect,